

CSS Style Sheets

CSS means *cascading style sheet*. It is simply a file that goes along with your html file which specifies the look and formatting of the html file. We will illustrate this with a simple example.

First create a file called *thecssfile.css* and place it in the same folder as your html file. In this example, we will see how to specify how text with certain tags appears - what font is used, what style, and what size.

Note: Comments in a css file are lines which are ignored by the browser. These are enclosed between the characters */*...*/*.

```
/* Example comment that would be ignored */
```

What you do in a css file is list tags used in the html file and specify values for various attributes enclosed in curly braces.

```
tag_name{  
  
    properties  
  
}
```

For example, we can specify the font used and text size for an h1 header.

```
h1 {  
    font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;  
    font-size: 24px;  
    font-style: bold;  
    font-variant: normal;  
    font-weight: 700;
```

```
line-height: 26.3999996185303px;
}
```

If you wanted all text in your html file that was enclosed in paragraph tags <p> to have helvetica neue font with size 12 pixels, you would write:

```
p {
  font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;
  font-size: 12px;
  font-style: normal;
  font-variant: normal;
  font-weight: 400;
  line-height: 20px;
}
```

Or suppose that we want all quotes on our web page to have italic font. We can do this by specifying the properties of the block quote tag in our css file:

```
blockquote {
  font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;
  font-size: 21px;
  font-style: italic;
  font-variant: normal;
  font-weight: 400;
  line-height: 30px;
}
```

As you learn more css you will be able to make very fancy web pages, but with this simple example we are seeing some advantages of using css. One is that we can have all block quotes appear in italics with other specified font properties without having to type in tags every single time in our html file.

Here is the complete code of this css file:

```
/* The CSS File */
```

```
h1 {  
    font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;  
    font-size: 24px;  
    font-style: bold;  
    font-variant: normal;  
    font-weight: 700;  
    line-height: 26.3999996185303px;  
}
```

```
h3 {  
    font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;  
    font-size: 14px;  
    font-style: normal;  
    font-variant: normal;  
    font-weight: 500;  
    line-height: 15.3999996185303px;  
}
```

```
p {  
    font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;  
    font-size: 14px;  
    font-style: normal;  
    font-variant: normal;  
    font-weight: 400;  
    line-height: 20px;  
}
```

```
blockquote {  
    font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;  
    font-size: 21px;  
    font-style: italic;  
    font-variant: normal;  
    font-weight: 400;  
    line-height: 30px;
```

```
}  
pre {  
    font-family: Arial, 'Helvetica Neue', Helvetica, sans-serif;  
    font-size: 13px;  
    font-style: normal;  
    font-variant: normal;  
    font-weight: 400;  
    line-height: 1.85714302062988px;  
}
```

To use the css file, you need to add a reference to it in your header section of the html file. This is placed in between the header tags <head> and </head>. The important line to add is:

```
<link href="thecssfile.css" rel="stylesheet" type="text/css">
```

Be sure that the href is correct, or that the .css file is in the same folder as your html file. There are some other codes necessary to include in the header section but we won't worry about what they do just yet and just make sure they are listed:

```
<html>  
<head>  
<title>CSS Example</title>  
<meta http-equiv="Content-Type"  
content="text/html; charset=iso-8859-1">  
<link href="thecssfile.css" rel="stylesheet" type="text/css">  
</head>
```

Then we can add some things to our html body:

```
<body>  
<h1>My Great Web Page</h1>
```

```
<pre>This is some random text written for<br>display on the web page. Hello
world<br>hello world hello world hello world.<br></pre>

<br>

<q></q>

<blockquote><q>This is the best day in the world!</q></blockquote>

<br>

<br>

</body>

</html>
```

Now that we have specified the css file in the header, all the text listed in the body will automatically take on the properties specified, so for instance the quoted text will be in italics even though we didn't add `<i>` or `<em>` tags.

Element and id Selectors

Although in the last example we created an external css file, this is not always necessary. You can include your style sheets directly in the `<head>`, `</head>` tags. Let's look at this and do so examining two ways to proceed.

An element selector is like we did in the previous lesson. We pick an element (or think of it as a type of tag), such as a header, block quote, or paragraph, and then specify its properties. If you create a style sheet and specify the properties for an h3 header, you are creating an element selector.

For example, we can specify styles for `<p>`, `<h1>`, and `<h2>` for a given web page:

```
<head>

<style>

p{
```

```
color: blue;
text-align:center;
}
h2{
text-decoration: underline;
text-align:center;
color: red;
}
h1{
text-shadow: 2px 2px #0000ff;
}
</style>
<title>Example Web page</title>
</head>
```

Another way to set styles is to use an id selector. In this case rather than defining properties for a specific element you simply define the properties you want and assign it an identifier.

```
#mytag {
text-align:center;
color:green;
}
```

Here we have created an element with identifier “mytag”. In this case you set an html element in your page to have these properties by setting its id attribute:

```
<p id=“mytag”>Hello from vactionland.</p>
```

Element and id selectors can be mixed in the same style sheet.

```
<html>
<head>
```

```
<style>
p{
color: blue;
text-align:center;
}
h2{
text-decoration: underline;
text-align:center;
color: red;
}
#mytag {
text-align:center;
color:green;
}
h1{
text-shadow: 2px 2px #0000ff;
}
</style>
<title></title>
</head>
```

In this case, if we just use <p>, the text will be blue, but if we use <p id=“mytag”>, the text will appear green. Hence, we can apply the style we need at will:

```
<body>
<h1>My Great Web Page</h1>
<p>Example text for a paragraph</p>
<br>
<br>
<h2>Second Header</h2>
<br>
<p id=“mytag”>Hello from vactionland.</p>
<p>Here is a second paragraph string.</p>
```